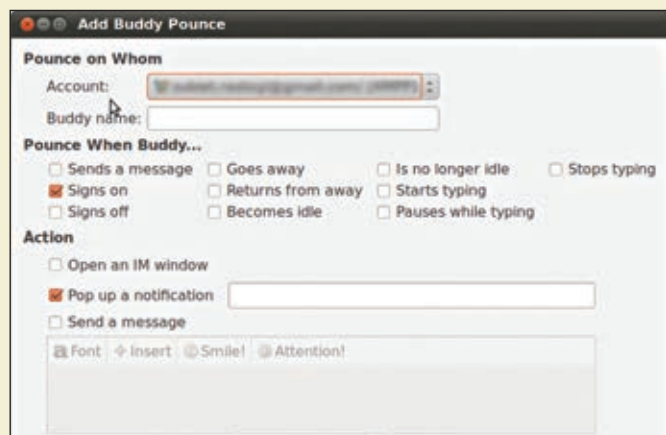


such as MSN, Google Talk and Yahoo! at the same time from within the same program. It provides basic text exchange and even audio/video chat capabilities on some protocols. It works on the Linux, Mac and Windows.

Facebook Chat

Pidgin supports multiple IM services including Google



Schedule your IM Needs

Talk, MSN, Yahoo and even slightly obscure ones as MXit and QQ, but it surprisingly leaves Facebook out of the default set. To fix this simply go to tinyurl.com/pdgn-fb. On the right-hand side navigation menu, you will find a *.deb package and *.exe package for Linux and Windows users, respectively for a straight forward install. Once installed, Facebook will show as an additional service when adding an account.

Audio/Video chat

Pidgin has added support for both Audio and Video. Just go to the 'Media' option for the buddy you want to initiate a chat with and select only 'Audio' or 'Audio and Video'. To further customise, you can enable the 'Voice/Video Settings' plugin from the **Tools > Plugins** dialog box and click on the 'Configure Button' to adjust your webcam and audio settings.

Text replacement

You can enable this by going to **Tools > Plugins > Text Replacements**. Not only does it automatically correct for mistakes/shorthands such as wroking to working, or anyl to anyone, you can also add your own entries by clicking on **Configure Plugin**. You can reduce your keystrokes by assigning short-

cuts/acronyms for your commonly used phrases.

Turn off notifications

With typically 200+ people on your buddy list a loud bell alert for every time when ever someone logs in or out can be annoying. To set this right, go to **Tools > Preferences > Sounds** and either reduce the notification volume to a bare minimum, or untick everything from the "Sound Events" section. If you fancy the notifications, but want a different tone, you can set that as well.

Buddy Pounces

This is a unique and incredibly useful feature of pidgin. Buddy pounces are actions (Like sending them a message, playing a specific sound, or even executing a command) whenever a certain friend in any of your protocols changes his status (say comes online, goes offline, becomes idle).

You can set them by going to **Tools>Buddy Pounces**.

One of the most common actions is to send a message whenever your buddy comes online, very useful in protocols which don't support offline messaging.

Keep it updated

On Ubuntu there is a version available in the repository but is typically not the most latest one, to fix this permanently simply go to <http://pidgin.im/download/ubuntu/> and download their Pidgin PPA package and install it. Whenever you update your repositories, it will always show the latest version of Pidgin.

Windows users can manually grab the latest version from <http://pidgin.im/download/windows/>.

Offline Messaging

Since now Google Talk among a few others support Offline Messaging, a simple trick to ease that process from within Pidgin is to go to **Buddies > Show > Off Line Buddies** and check it, followed by **Buddies > Sort Buddies > By Status**.

Current Playing Song in Status Message: If you want the song you're listening on your computer to appear as your status message, you can install this plugin from <http://code.google.com/p/pidgin-musictracker/>.

There is an executable package for Windows user available and source file for Linux users, but Linux users are advised to check their respective repository listing for an entry.

It supports a large number of music players including Winamp, Windows media player, Last.fm feed, Amarok, Banshee, Rhythmbox among many others so you can listen to music from the player of your choice without installing a separate add-on in each player.

Maya

Autodesk Maya 2011 is one of the most powerful 3D applications and is used in a lot of industries around the globe for various things from Game Design and development to Movie making.

Changing Maya UI

A handful of people don't like new look of Maya and aren't entirely sure on how to change the interface without breaking the software. A quick and easy way is to locate your Maya.exe file and create a shortcut on your desktop. Right-click on the icon and select **Properties**. You will see the **Target Line** which gives you the path to the maya.exe file. Insert a space after the quotes and type **-style plastique**. Click on **apply** and see the UI change dramatically.

Once you have achieved that, you can play with different types of UI style codes: **Plastique**, **cde**, **motif**, **cleanlooks**, **windows**, **monolith**.

If you wish to go to the default UI, then simply delete **-style name**.

Handy shortcuts

[F] = Frame objects in selected view
 [Shift] + [F] = Frame all objects in all views
 [G] = Repeat Last
 [P] = ParentING OBJECTS
 [S] = Set a keyframe
 [Z] = Undo
 [Shift] + [Z] = Redo

Physical Sun and Sky

An easier way to get an interesting looking sun and sky for your objects is with the physical sun and sky.

To do this make sure your render settings are on **Mental ray**. If it isn't, then click on the slate board looking icon. In these settings you will see a **Quality** tab, change the quality preset to **production**. Next we go to the **Indirect Lighting** tab and click on the "Create" Button next to